

off your blouse. Also, wear an apron while cooking. I've ruined many a lovely dress over a pot of simmering bolognese.

3. Stop laundering so often

Washing an item of clothing is the fastest way to help the fibers break down. The fewer times you have to wash an item of clothing, the longer it will last. And realistically, as long as you weren't sweating up a storm, you can get a few wears out of a dress shirt before needing to throw it into the wash.

Create a system that allows you to remember which items of clothing have been worn (if you are too lazy to rehang lightly worn clothing, it's okay to drape it over surfaces like your dresser or a chair, just as long as it doesn't drop on the floor). The following items can also help you wear a shirt or a pair of pants more than once before washing:

Tide to Go pen

These little pens cost less than \$5, last for a long time, and will save your blouse when you manage to drop a dollop of marinara down the front. Coworkers and friends are always wowed by how quickly this trick works to remove stains from fabric. I use a Shout gel brush stain

remover as well, on large stains, but the Tide pen allows you to use the stain treatment without having to wash the clothing item immediately thereafter.

Lint Roller

Sometimes a pair of black slacks doesn't really need to be washed—it just needs the cat hair removed from around the cuffs. My white dog really loves to jump on my lap whenever I'm wearing dark colors (it's like he *knows*), and it's not that he's dirty—he just sheds like it's going out of style. I have lint rollers in every room of my house, and they keep my slacks looking professional. I also keep one at the office to pick up stray hair and fluff that inevitably lands on my back and shoulders during long days spent scratching my head.

Deodorant

Your shirts will smell better and stand up to multiple wearings if you yourself don't stink.

4. Keep all those buttons

Every time you buy a new piece of clothing that comes with spare buttons, immediately put the buttons in a jar or box reserved entirely for buttons and spare thread. It's easy to lose track of these important